

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
KINGS COUNTY-----X  
LEON MCPHERSON & SHERMAN MCPHERSON,

## SUMMONS

Plaintiffs,

Index #

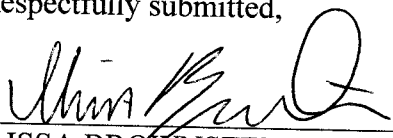
-against-

Basis of Venue: Place of  
IncidentTHE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER  
CHRISTOPHER CARBONE (SHIELD # 13348),  
POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE #1, POLICE OFFICERS  
JOHN DOES #2-4 (names and numbers of who is unknown  
At present), and other unidentified members of the New York  
City Police Department,Plaintiff designates King  
County as the place of trial.Defendants.  
-----X**To the above named Defendants:**

**You are hereby summoned** to answer the complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York  
March 19, 2015

Respectfully submitted,

  
\_\_\_\_\_  
LISSA BROWNSTEIN, ESQ.  
Attorney for Plaintiff  
65 Broadway (Suites 813 & 814)  
New York, New York 10006  
(212) 691-3333CITY OF NEW YORK: CORPORATION COUNSEL  
100 Church Street New York, NY 10007POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER CARBONE (SHIELD #13348)  
Brooklyn North Gang Squad (BNGS), Brooklyn, New York

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
KINGS COUNTY

-----X  
LEON MCPHERSON & SHERMAN MCPHERSON,

**VERIFIED COMPLAINT**

Plaintiffs,

Index #

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER  
CHRISTOPHER CARBONE (SHIELD # 13348),  
POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE #1, POLICE OFFICERS  
JOHN DOES #2-4 (names and numbers of who is unknown  
At present), and other unidentified members of the New York  
City Police Department,

Defendants.

-----X  
Plaintiffs **Leon McPherson** and **Sherman McPherson**, by their attorney, ILISSA BROWNSTEIN,  
ESQ., as and for the Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

**PRELIMINARY STATEMENT**

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Section 1983, the rights secured by the First, Fourth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution and the laws of the State of New York. Plaintiff was unlawfully arrested by the defendants. Plaintiff was deprived of his federal constitutional and state constitutional and common law rights when the individually named police officer defendants unlawfully confined plaintiff, caused the unjustifiable arrest of plaintiff and malicious prosecution of plaintiff. Defendants additionally used excessive force in violation of Plaintiff's constitutional rights protected by the Eighth Amendment and the state tort laws.

**PARTIES**

2. Plaintiff Leon McPherson is a citizen of the United States and a resident of Brooklyn, New York.
3. Plaintiff Sherman McPherson is a citizen of the United States and a resident of Brooklyn, New York.
4. Police Officer Christopher Carbone (Shield # 13348) is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
5. Police Officer Christopher Carbone (Shield # 13348) is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.

6. Police Officer John Doe #1 is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
7. Police Officer John Doe #1 is being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
8. New York Police Officers John Doe #2-4 are and were at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
9. Police Officers John Doe #2-4 are being sued in his individual capacity and official capacity.
10. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents, and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.
11. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department which acts as agents in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.
12. Plaintiffs in furtherance of his State causes of action filed a timely (with regard to some claims) Notice of Claim upon the City of New York in compliance with Municipal Law Section 50.
13. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and the City of New York has failed to pay or adjust the claim.
14. The City of New York held a 50(H) hearing examination of the Plaintiff on January 9, 2015.

## **STATEMENT OF FACTS**

15. Leon McPherson was 37 years old at the time of his arrest. In 2012, he received his certificate as a Plumber Helper. Sherman McPherson was 35 years old at the time of his arrest. Sherman McPherson is currently a self-employed barber.
16. On February 14, 2014, at approximately 5:45 pm, at 542 Chauncey Street, Apartment #2 in Brooklyn, New York, Leon and Sherman McPherson were hanging out at their friend's place when the police unlawfully entered the apartment.
17. The police searched the house and claimed they found drugs and marijuana in the apartment.
18. Both Leon and Sherman McPherson never saw any drugs or marijuana in the apartment.
19. The police proceeded to arrest Leon McPherson and Sherman McPherson for possession of marijuana.
20. Leon McPherson was incarcerated for approximately 24 hours before he was ROR'ed at arraignment.
21. Leon McPherson attended 3 court appearances.
22. Leon McPherson's money was seized and not returned.
23. Sherman McPherson was incarcerated for approximately 24 hours before he was ROR'ed at his arraignment.
24. Sherman McPherson attended 3 court appearances.
25. Sherman McPherson's money was seized and not returned.
26. On August 29, 2014, their case was dismissed on motion of the prosecutor.
27. Plaintiffs filed a notice of claim on October 2, 2014.

## **FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION**

### **VIOLATION OF PLAINTIFFS' FOURTH AMENDMENT AND FOURTEENTH AMENDMENT RIGHTS**

28. The plaintiffs repeat, reiterate and reallege each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 27 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
29. The individually named defendants who acted in concert and within the scope of their authority at the NYPD arrested and caused plaintiffs to be imprisoned without probable cause, maliciously prosecuted, and subjected to excessive forced based as well as an unlawful search in violation of plaintiffs' right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty and the right to privacy under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

## **SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION**

### **FALSE ARREST AND FALSE IMPRISONMENT**

30. Plaintiffs repeat and reallege paragraphs 1 through 29 as if fully set forth herein.
31. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine plaintiffs and, in fact, confined plaintiffs, and plaintiffs were conscious of the confinement. In addition, plaintiffs did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.
32. The individually named defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
33. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

### **THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **MALICIOUS PROSECUTION**

34. The plaintiffs repeat, reiterate and reallege each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 33 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
35. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the Fourth Amendment to the United States Constitution.
36. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against plaintiffs.
37. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against plaintiffs and for each of the charges for which they were prosecuted.
38. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated favorably to plaintiffs on August 29, 2014.
39. Plaintiffs were subjected to a post-arraignment deprivation of liberty sufficient to implicate plaintiffs' Fourth Amendment rights.
40. The individually named defendant Police Officers were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

### **FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **NEGLIGENT HIRING, RETENTION, TRAINING AND SUPERVISION**

41. The plaintiffs repeat, reiterate and reallege each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 40 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
42. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise the individually named defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of NYPD duties.

## **FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

### **FAILURE TO INTERVENE**

43. The plaintiffs repeat, reiterate and reallege each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 42 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
44. Defendants had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of plaintiffs, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other members of the NYPD.
45. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.
46. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiffs were subjected to an illegal search.
47. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of his employment by the City of New York, the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
48. The City, as the employer of defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

## **SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

### **NEGLIGENCE**

49. The plaintiffs repeat, reiterate and reallege each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 48 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
50. Defendants owed a duty of care to plaintiffs.
51. Defendants breached that duty of care by subjecting them to an illegal search.
52. As a direct and proximate cause of this unlawful conduct, plaintiffs sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.
53. All of the foregoing occurred without any fault by plaintiffs.
54. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

## **SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

### **NEGLIGENT INFLICTION OF EMOTIONAL DISTRESS**

55. The plaintiffs repeat, reiterate and reallege each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 54 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
56. By the actions described herein, the individually named police officer defendants, each acting individually and in concert with one another, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to plaintiffs. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to plaintiffs and violated plaintiffs' statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.
57. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiffs were deprived of liberty and sustained great emotional injuries.
58. The City, as the employer of the defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat behavior.

## **EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

### **MUNICIPAL LIABILITY UNDER 42 U.S.C. § 1983**

59. The plaintiffs repeat, reiterate and reallege each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 58 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
60. Defendants, collectively and individually, while acting under color of state law, engaged in conduct that constituted a custom, usage, practice, procedure or rule of defendant City of New York, which is forbidden by the Constitution of the United States.
61. The aforementioned customs, policies, usages, practices, procedures and rules of defendant City of New York and the New York Police Department included, but were not limited to policies, customs and practices wherein New York City Police officers arrest individuals without probable cause and create false versions of events to justify their actions.
62. The aforementioned customs, policies, usages, practices, procedures and rules of defendant City of New York and the New York Police Department were the moving force behind the violation of plaintiffs' constitutional rights as described herein. As a result of the failure of defendant City of New York and the New York City Police Department to properly recruit, screen, train, discipline, and supervise its officers, including the individual defendants,



defendant City of New York has tacitly authorized, ratified, and has been deliberately indifferent to, the acts and conduct complained of herein.

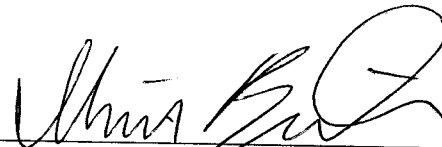
63. The foregoing customs, policies, usages, practices, and procedures and rules of defendant City of New York and the New York City Police Department were the moving force behind the Constitutional violations suffered by plaintiffs as alleged herein.
64. As a result of the foregoing customs, policies, usages, practices, and procedures and rules of defendant City of New York and the New York City Police Department, plaintiffs were unlawfully arrested and prosecuted.
65. Defendants collectively and individually, while acting under color of state law were directly and actively involved in violating plaintiffs' constitutional rights.

**WHEREFORE, LEON MCPHERSON & SHERMAN MCPHERSON,** plaintiffs, demands a judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this actions which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorney's fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as appropriate under the law.

Dated: New York, New York  
March 19, 2015

Respectfully submitted:

By:



ILISSA BROWNSTEIN, ESQ.

Attorney for Plaintiff

65 Broadway

Suites 813 & 814

New York, New York 10006

(212) 691-3333

TO: CITY OF NEW YORK  
CORPORATION COUNSEL  
100 Church Street  
New York, New York 10007

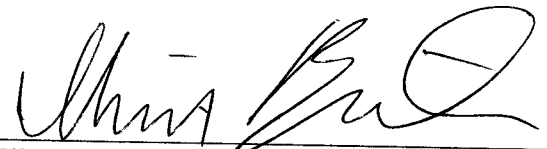
POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER CARBONE (SHIELD #13348)  
Brooklyn North Gang Squad (BNGS)  
Brooklyn, New York

**ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION**

**ILISSA BROWNSTEIN**, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am attorney at the law firm of **ILISSA BROWNSTEIN, ESQ.**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters wherein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff's is that Plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York  
March 19, 2015

  
\_\_\_\_\_  
Ilissa Brownstein, Esq.